

CONNECTING ARDUINO To The Internet

If you have just begun working with Arduino, connecting to the internet can be a daunting task. The author remembers his own struggles with it in his early days of Arduino coding. With the lack of a proper interface and no inbuilt debugging tools, it can be hard to figure out where you went wrong. In this article, we shall cover everything you need to know about connecting your Arduino board to the internet, including the code

MIR H.S. QUADRI is a research analyst with a specialisation in artificial intelligence and machine learning. He is the founder of Arkinfo, which focuses on the research and development of tech products using new-age technologies. He shares a deep love for analysis of technological trends and understanding its implications. Being a FOSS enthusiast, he has contributed to several open source projects

When I first began playing around with my Arduino Uno, I was very proud of making LEDs blink and sensors beep. But I soon realised that the true potential of an Arduino can only be achieved once you connect it to the internet.

Pretty much any intermediate to advanced level Arduino project will require you to connect to the internet for various reasons, be it logging data on the cloud such as weather data or passing on real-time commands to your device remotely such as via an app on your phone.

In this tutorial article, we are going to look at how to connect your Arduino device to the internet comprehensively. Everything—from the hardware to the circuit and code—will be covered.

Connecting via the Ethernet

The first option for connecting your Arduino to the internet is via an Ethernet cable. If you are using an Arduino board that comes with a built-in Ethernet port such as an Arduino Yún, you can skip the ‘Hardware requirements’ section and the

circuit design description given below. Just connect the Ethernet cable to your device and start coding. However, if, like most people, you own a simpler version of Arduino such as Arduino Uno that does not have a built-in Ethernet port, you will have to buy a separate device, called Ethernet shield, to attach to your Arduino.

Hardware requirements

You will require an Ethernet cable with internet, an Arduino Uno board, and an Ethernet Shield. Here’s how to connect them:

1. Connect the Ethernet shield on top of the Arduino Uno.
2. Connect the Ethernet cable to the Ethernet shield.

Fig. 1 shows Arduino Uno and its Ethernet shield. After connecting the two, your Arduino Uno should look like the one in Fig. 2.

The code

Before getting started with the code for connecting Arduino to the internet, we need

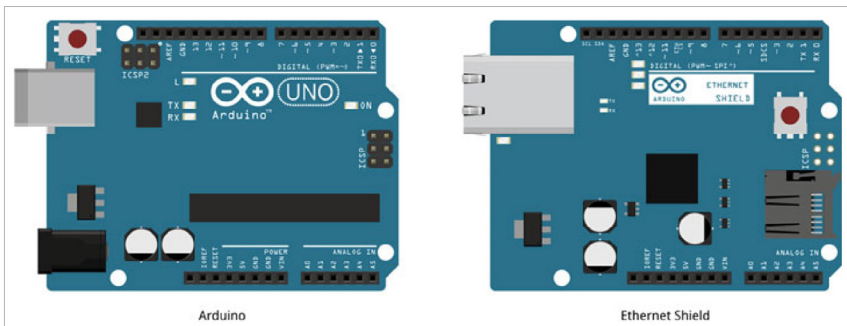


Fig. 1: Arduino Uno and Ethernet shield

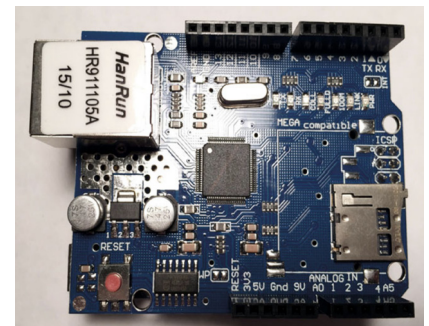


Fig. 2: Ethernet shield attached to Arduino Uno